

PERILS & EXCLUSIONS REFERENCE GUIDE

HomeShield Insurance Group | 2025 Edition | All Plan Tiers

This reference guide provides a definitive summary of what is and is not covered for each insured peril under HomeShield policies. Use this document to answer coverage questions and resolve disputes about claim eligibility.

PERIL COVERAGE MATRIX

Peril	Buildings Standard	Buildings Comp.	Buildings Landlord	Contents Standard	Contents Comp.	Contents Landlord
Fire and smoke	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Lightning strike	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Explosion	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Storm damage	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Flood	✓ (Flood Re)	✓ (Flood Re)	✓ (Flood Re)	✓	✓	✓
Escape of water (burst pipe)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Theft (forced entry)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	Limited
Malicious damage / vandalism	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Malicious damage by tenant	✗	✗	✓ (£25k)	✗	✗	✓
Subsidence / heave / landslip	✓ (£1k excess)	✓ (£1k excess)	✓ (£1k excess)	✗	✗	✗
Falling trees / objects	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Vehicle / aircraft impact	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Accidental damage	Add-on only	✓ included	Buildings ✓	Add-on only	✓ included	Add-on
Leaking oil from heating	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗
Frozen food spoilage	N/A	N/A	N/A	✓ (£500)	✓ (£500)	✓ (£500)
Theft away from home	✗	✓ (£5,000)	✗	✗	✓ (£5,000)	✗
Bicycle theft	N/A	N/A	N/A	✗	✓ (£1k/bike)	✗
Wear and tear / deterioration	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Mechanical / electrical breakdown	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Unoccupancy > 60 days (standard)	Exclusions apply	Exclusions apply	90 days	Exclusions apply	Exclusions apply	90 days

COMMON COVERAGE DISPUTES AND RULINGS

Scenario	Coverage Decision	Reason / Policy Section
Roof leaked during heavy rain; no storm damage	Not covered	Gradual deterioration; not a sudden storm event; maintenance exclusion applies
Pipe froze and burst during winter, causing ceiling damage	Covered	Escape of water from pipe; sudden event; trace and access included

Scenario	Coverage Decision	Reason / Policy Section
Groundwater rose from below floor after heavy rain	Not covered	Groundwater seepage is classified as subsidence/heave, not flood; specific exclusion
Storm blew fence panel off	Not covered (fences)	Fences, gates, and hedges excluded from storm and flood coverage
Storm blew boundary wall down (structural brick wall)	Covered	Structural walls within boundary are included; not a fence
Burglar entered through unlocked patio door	Not covered	No forced entry; theft requires evidence of forcible and violent entry or exit
Tenant caused significant damage to kitchen units	Landlord Plus only: Covered	Malicious damage by tenants: Landlord Plus up to £25,000; not covered on Standard or Comprehensive
Contents stolen from unlocked outbuilding	Not covered	Outbuilding theft requires evidence that outbuilding was locked at time of theft
Laptop damaged by accidental spill at home	Comprehensive: Covered Standard: Not covered (unless add-on)	Accidental damage included in Comprehensive; add-on required for Standard
Tree root caused subsidence crack in wall	Covered (with £1,000 excess)	Subsidence from tree roots is covered if structural damage proven; excess applies
Drain cleared of tree roots causing flooding in garden	Not covered	Preventive maintenance work is not an insured event; only resultant damage to the building is covered
Fire caused by electrical fault behind walls (rewiring needed)	Partial cover	Fire damage covered; cost of rewiring to prevent recurrence is maintenance, not covered
Jewellery lost at home (not stolen)	Not covered	Contents cover requires a specific insured peril (theft, fire, etc.); unexplained disappearance not covered
Jewellery lost while travelling (away from home)	Comprehensive only: Covered	Away-from-home cover: Comprehensive up to £5,000; Standard: not covered
Subsidence damage found on newly built property (3 years old)	Not covered	Normal settlement exclusion applies to properties under 10 years old; may be covered by NHBC warranty

DISCLAIMER: Synthetic data for training use only.